

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

Quick Key

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Detailed solutions

Q1. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement about Article 13 is constitutionally accurate?

A. Law includes custom or usage with the force of law, while constitutional amendments follow Article 368 and basic-structure review. - CORRECT: Correct: the option accurately separates Article 13's broad ordinary-law definition from the constitutional-amendment control path.

B. Custom is excluded because only enacted measures are law. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 13(3)(a) expressly includes custom or usage having in India the force of law.

C. Every invalid provision necessarily destroys the entire enactment. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the phrase 'to the extent' supports severability where the valid remainder is workable and consistent with legislative intent.

D. A constitutional amendment is reviewed exactly like an ordinary notification under Article 13(2). - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 13(4) and Kesavananda Bharati place amendment review on the Article 368/basic-structure route.

Method / explanation: the option accurately separates Article 13's broad ordinary-law definition from the constitutional-amendment control path.

Trap: The question turns on two different meanings of law: Article 13 ordinary law and Article 368 constitutional amendment.

Q2. Answer: B | Polity

Which pair is correctly distinguished?

A. Both terms describe provincial dyarchy under 1919 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Provincial dyarchy was a 1919 division between reserved and transferred subjects; it was unrelated to either eighteenth-century arrangement.

B. Bengal Dual Government: 1765-72; metropolitan double government: Board of Control plus Court of Directors - CORRECT: Correct. Bengal's Dual Government separated effective Company revenue power from the Nawab's nominal responsibility in 1765-72; Pitt's system divided metropolitan supervision between the Board of Control and Court of Directors.

C. Both began with the Charter Act 1833 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Bengal's Dual Government began after the 1765 Diwani and ended in 1772, while metropolitan double government began under Pitt's India Act 1784-not in 1833.

D. Double government means Governor plus elected ministers under 1935 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The 1935 Act abolished provincial dyarchy and introduced provincial autonomy; "double government" is not a label for a Governor and elected ministers under that Act.

Method / explanation: Correct. Bengal's Dual Government separated effective Company revenue power from the Nawab's nominal responsibility in 1765-72; Pitt's system divided metropolitan supervision between the Board of Control and Court of Directors.

Trap: Distinguish Bengal's 1765-72 Dual Government from Pitt's metropolitan double government after 1784.

Q3. Answer: C | Polity

Which statement correctly maps Part XIV?

A. Articles 308-323 form a single code only for All-India Services. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Part XIV covers more than AIS and deliberately separates service relations from Commission institutions.

B. Articles 315-323 govern discipline, while Article 311 establishes UPSC. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 311 protects specified civil personnel; UPSC is constituted under Article 315.

C. Articles 308-314 govern services; Articles 315-323 govern Public Service Commissions. - CORRECT: Correct. Chapter I of Part XIV addresses services through Articles 308-314, while Chapter II separately creates the Public Service Commission framework in Articles 315-323.

D. Article 323A is part of the Articles 315-323 Commission chapter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 323A belongs to Part XIV-A on administrative tribunals, not the Commission chapter.

Method / explanation: Correct. Chapter I of Part XIV addresses services through Articles 308-314, while Chapter II separately creates the Public Service Commission framework in Articles 315-323.

Trap: Keep service law, Public Service Commissions and administrative tribunals in their separate constitutional locations.

Q4. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement about identifying the basic structure is constitutionally safest?

A. Kesavananda Bharati unanimously published a closed list binding every later case. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The judges produced overlapping opinions, not a single exhaustive catalogue endorsed in identical terms.

B. Only features written in the Preamble can qualify. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Preamble is important evidence, but structural features also arise from Parts, Articles and institutional design.

C. Any value mentioned by one judge automatically invalidates future amendments. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. A feature claim still requires constitutional grounding, precedent and proof of damage by the challenged amendment.

D. The doctrine is non-exhaustive and case-attributed; later cases identify features in their own factual and constitutional settings. - CORRECT: Correct. Attribution distinguishes the core limitation from particular features developed through Indira Gandhi, Minerva Mills, Bommai, L. Chandra Kumar and NJAC.

Method / explanation: Attribution distinguishes the core limitation from particular features developed through Indira Gandhi, Minerva Mills, Bommai, L. Chandra Kumar and NJAC.

Trap: Name the case attached to the feature and avoid the phrase "the Supreme Court's final list".

Q5. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement correctly distinguishes Articles 253 and 356-357?

A. Article 253 implements international obligations; a law under Articles 356-357 may continue after President's Rule until altered by competent authority. - CORRECT: Correct. The first is an external-obligation route; the second has a distinct post-proclamation survival rule.

B. Both require prior resolutions of two State legislatures. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Neither route depends on Article 252-style resolutions by two or more State legislatures.

C. Both laws cease immediately when their triggering event ends. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 357(2) expressly preserves a law after the proclamation until it is altered, repealed or amended.

D. Article 253 is confined to Union List matters, while Article 356 excludes State subjects. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 253 can reach a State field for international implementation, while Articles 356-357 concern State legislative power.

Method / explanation: Correct. The first is an external-obligation route; the second has a distinct post-proclamation survival rule.

Trap: The six-month tails of Articles 249 and 250 must not be copied into the different Article 357 continuation rule.

Q6. Answer: B | Polity

Retirement and removal Which statement is correct?

A. A High Court judge retires at 65 and is removable by the Governor. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. This choice conflicts with the controlling proposition: Articles 217 and 218 set retirement at sixty-two and apply the stringent Supreme Court removal framework. Therefore 'A High Court judge retires at 65 and is removable by the Governor.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

B. A High Court judge ordinarily retires at 62 and uses the Article 124(4)-type removal route through Article 218. - CORRECT: Correct. This option states the operative rule: Articles 217 and 218 set retirement at sixty-two and apply the stringent Supreme Court removal framework. Therefore 'A High Court judge ordinarily retires at 62 and uses the Article 124(4)-type removal route through Article 218.' states the operative position.

C. A High Court judge holds office during presidential pleasure. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The option collapses a distinction preserved by the governing rule: Articles 217 and 218 set retirement at sixty-two and apply the stringent Supreme Court removal framework. Therefore 'A High Court judge holds office during presidential pleasure.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

D. Parliament removes a judge by ordinary majority. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. This formulation overstates, understates or misattributes the rule: Articles 217 and 218 set retirement at sixty-two and apply the stringent Supreme Court removal framework. Therefore 'Parliament removes a judge by ordinary majority.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

Method / explanation: Correct. This option states the operative rule: Articles 217 and 218 set retirement at sixty-two and apply the stringent Supreme Court removal framework. Therefore 'A High Court judge ordinarily retires at 62 and uses the Article 124(4)-type removal route through Article 218.' states the operative position.

Trap: Appointment by the President does not create pleasure tenure.

Q7. Answer: C | Polity

The statement 'liberty in the Preamble is absolute' is incorrect because:

A. The Preamble contains no liberty objective - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Liberty is one of the four express objectives.

B. Only economic liberty is recognised - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The named liberties concern thought, expression, belief, faith and worship, not a sole economic category.

C. Constitutional liberty operates with lawful limits protecting rights, order and the common good - CORRECT: Correct. Freedom is essential to personality but is not licence to disregard constitutionally valid restrictions or others' rights.

D. Liberty belongs exclusively to non-citizens - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Preamble states that these objectives are to be secured to all citizens.

Method / explanation: Correct. Freedom is essential to personality but is not licence to disregard constitutionally valid restrictions or others' rights.

Trap: The safe distinction is liberty versus licence, not liberty versus regulation.

Q8. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement about Article 263 is correct?

A. It automatically creates a permanent court for all inter-State disputes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 263 is enabling and consultative; adjudicatory routes arise from other constitutional or statutory provisions.

B. It makes every council recommendation binding on Parliament and States. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Inter-State Council's recommendations do not acquire binding legislative force merely through Article 263.

C. It concerns only the distribution of tax revenues. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Fiscal distribution is centred on provisions such as Articles 270 and 280.

D. It enables the President to establish a council for inquiry, discussion and recommendation on intergovernmental questions. - CORRECT: Correct. The provision can support investigation, discussion and recommendations to improve coordination.

Method / explanation: Correct. The provision can support investigation, discussion and recommendations to improve coordination.

Trap: Consultation, adjudication and legislation are distinct functions even when all address intergovernmental conflict.

Q9. Answer: A | Polity

Which institutional pair was abolished in 1858?

A. Court of Directors and Board of Control - CORRECT: Correct. The Court of Directors and Board of Control-the two arms of metropolitan double government-were abolished when Company rule ended.

B. Governor-General and provincial governors - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Governor-General and provincial governors continued; the Governor-General additionally acted as Viceroy after the Crown transfer.

C. Supreme Court and High Courts - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Calcutta Supreme Court was not abolished by the 1858 transfer, and the statutory High Courts were established later under the 1861 legislation.

D. Legislative Assembly and Council of State - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Legislative Assembly and Council of State were created under the 1919 bicameral settlement and did not exist in 1858.

Method / explanation: Correct. The Court of Directors and Board of Control-the two arms of metropolitan double government-were abolished when Company rule ended.

Trap: Identify what metropolitan double government contained before deciding which institutions the Crown transfer abolished.

Q10. Answer: B | Polity

Which statement most accurately reflects the 11 December 2023 Article 370 judgment?

A. It restored the former Article 370 arrangement and the separate J&K Constitution. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Court upheld the application of the Constitution of India without the former special arrangement.

B. It upheld the 2019 constitutional changes, accepted Ladakh's Union Territory status and recorded an assurance of J&K statehood restoration without deciding the reorganisation issue finally. - CORRECT: Correct. This formulation preserves the judgment's holding, the assurance and the issue the Court did not finally determine.

C. It fixed a legally binding calendar date for restoration of J&K statehood. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It directed Assembly elections by a date but did not prescribe a date for restoration of statehood.

D. It held that Ladakh could not remain a Union Territory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Court accepted the Union Territory status of Ladakh in the operative disposition.

Method / explanation: Correct. This formulation preserves the judgment's holding, the assurance and the issue the Court did not finally determine.

Trap: Separate the Article 370 holding, Ladakh's status, the election direction and the un-fixed statehood question.

Q11. Answer: C | Polity

Consider the Charter Act 1813: 1. Tea and China monopoly remained. 2. An annual education sum was sanctioned. 3. Company government ended. Which are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 1 is true, but statement 2 is also true because the Act sanctioned an annual sum for literature, learned Indians and scientific knowledge.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 2 is true, but statement 3 is false: Company government continued until the Crown transfer of 1858.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct. The tea-and-China exceptions remained and the annual education grant was authorised; the Act did not terminate Company administration.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Including statement 3 makes this combination wrong because the East India Company continued to govern after 1813.

Method / explanation: Correct. The tea-and-China exceptions remained and the annual education grant was authorised; the Act did not terminate Company administration.

Trap: In statement combinations, remember that 1813 changed trade and education but did not end Company government.

Q12. Answer: D | Polity

Which classification statement is most accurate?

A. Article 48A is constitutionally labelled Gandhian. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Article 48A is constitutionally labelled Gandhian." fails against the controlling rule. The threefold taxonomy is scholarly, not constitutional. Articles 43, 47 and 48 overlap in standard classifications.

B. Articles 47 and 48 can belong to only one scholarly category each. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Articles 47 and 48 can belong to only one scholarly category each." fails against the controlling rule. The threefold taxonomy is scholarly, not constitutional. Articles 43, 47 and 48 overlap in standard classifications.

C. Article 44 is classified as socialistic by the constitutional text. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Article 44 is classified as socialistic by the constitutional text." fails against the controlling rule. The threefold taxonomy is scholarly, not constitutional. Articles 43, 47 and 48 overlap in standard classifications.

D. Article 43 overlaps: living wage is commonly socialistic, while cottage industries give it a Gandhian dimension. - CORRECT: Correct: The threefold taxonomy is scholarly, not constitutional. Articles 43, 47 and 48 overlap in standard classifications. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: The threefold taxonomy is scholarly, not constitutional. Articles 43, 47 and 48 overlap in standard classifications. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: A textbook category helps revision but cannot displace the constitutional wording of an overlapping Article.

Q13. Answer: A | Economy

Which official status statement is accurate at the 9 September 2026 cutoff?

A. Micron's Sanand ATMP had commenced commercial production in February 2026. - CORRECT: Correct: The official ISM timeline uses this stage and date. The option states: Micron's Sanand ATMP had commenced commercial production in February 2026.

B. Every approved chip project was in commercial production. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Projects remained at different implementation stages. The option states: Every approved chip project was in commercial production.

C. HCL-Foxconn's project was located in Madhya Pradesh. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The recorded groundbreaking was at Jewar, Uttar Pradesh. The option states: HCL-Foxconn's project was located in Madhya Pradesh.

D. Crystal Matrix and Suchi Semicon were both operating silicon wafer fabs. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The May approvals cover compound fab-plus-ATMP and OSAT, not two operating silicon fabs. The option states: Crystal Matrix and Suchi Semicon were both operating silicon wafer fabs.

Method / explanation: The official ISM timeline uses this stage and date. The option states: Micron's Sanand ATMP had commenced commercial production in February 2026.

Trap: Use the exact stage verb for every project.

Q14. Answer: B | Economy

Which statement correctly distinguishes organic and natural farming?

A. The two labels are legally identical everywhere. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: They cannot be universally merged. The option states: The two labels are legally identical everywhere.

B. Organic follows defined standards/certification; natural farming is a distinct low-external-input approach and may not be certified organic. - CORRECT: Correct: Different standards, verification and input philosophies require separation. The option states: Organic follows defined standards/certification; natural farming is a distinct low-external-input approach and may not be certified organic.

C. Natural farming always permits every synthetic pesticide. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Natural farming seeks reduced synthetic inputs. The option states: Natural farming always permits every synthetic pesticide.

D. Organic farming means no nutrient management. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Organic systems still manage nutrients. The option states: Organic farming means no nutrient management.

Method / explanation: Different standards, verification and input philosophies require separation. The option states: Organic follows defined standards/certification; natural farming is a distinct low-external-input approach and may not be certified organic.

Trap: Low chemical use is not automatically certified organic.

Q15. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement best captures gains from trade?

A. Every household gains immediately - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Trade theory does not remove distributional conflict, mobility costs or transition lags. Option text: Every household gains immediately

B. Only exporters can gain - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Consumers and imported-input users can gain even when they do not export directly. Option text: Only exporters can gain

C. Aggregate gains can coexist with concentrated adjustment losses - CORRECT: Correct: This is correct because lower prices and specialisation gains can occur alongside worker, firm and regional displacement. Option text: Aggregate gains can coexist with concentrated adjustment losses

D. Imports reduce national welfare by definition - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Imports can expand consumption possibilities and productive input access, so their value is not intrinsically a welfare loss. Option text: Imports reduce national welfare by definition

Method / explanation: This is correct because lower prices and specialisation gains can occur alongside worker, firm and regional displacement. Option text: Aggregate gains can coexist with concentrated adjustment losses

Trap: Separate aggregate welfare from distribution and transition. Focus: which statement best captures gains from trade.

Q16. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement about e-NWR is correct?

A. Every informal storage slip is an e-NWR. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Informal slips lack the regulated framework. The option states: Every informal storage slip is an e-NWR.

B. An e-NWR guarantees a bank loan at zero risk. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Lenders still appraise credit and collateral. The option states: An e-NWR guarantees a bank loan at zero risk.

C. Pledging an e-NWR always transfers ownership to the lender immediately. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Pledge and ownership transfer are distinct. The option states: Pledging an e-NWR always transfers ownership to the lender immediately.

D. For WDRA-registered warehouses, electronic NWR issuance became mandatory from 1 June 2019 through recognised repositories. - CORRECT: Correct: The date and registered-warehouse perimeter are essential. The option states: For WDRA-registered warehouses, electronic NWR issuance became mandatory from 1 June 2019 through recognised repositories.

Method / explanation: The date and registered-warehouse perimeter are essential. The option states: For WDRA-registered warehouses, electronic NWR issuance became mandatory from 1 June 2019 through recognised repositories.

Trap: Receipt, pledge, ownership and commodity are separate.

Q17. Answer: A | Economy

Which statement captures early Green-Revolution concentration?

A. Gains were strongest in irrigated north-western wheat areas, with rice spreading later. - CORRECT: Correct: Complementary infrastructure concentrated early adoption geographically and by crop. The option states: Gains were strongest in irrigated north-western wheat areas, with rice spreading later.

B. Pulses and oilseeds led uniformly across rainfed India. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Pulses and oilseeds were less central initially. The option states: Pulses and oilseeds led uniformly across rainfed India.

C. Every district adopted simultaneously. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Diffusion was uneven over time. The option states: Every district adopted simultaneously.

D. The strategy was independent of procurement and irrigation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Irrigation and market support shaped adoption. The option states: The strategy was independent of procurement and irrigation.

Method / explanation: Complementary infrastructure concentrated early adoption geographically and by crop. The option states: Gains were strongest in irrigated north-western wheat areas, with rice spreading later.

Trap: National output success can coexist with regional disparity.

Q18. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following statements about Indian equity cash-market settlement: 1. T+1 is the standard cycle. 2. Optional T+0 operates in addition to T+1 under SEBI's phased framework. 3. T+0 necessarily means instantaneous settlement of every equity trade. Which of the statements given above are correct as at the 9 September 2026 cutoff?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The optional T+0 route also exists under the dated SEBI framework.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: SEBI's 2024 framework retained T+1 and added optional T+0; the 30 October 2025 circular further extended QSB implementation timing.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: T+1 remains standard and T+0 is same-day rather than necessarily instantaneous.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 overstates both speed and universality of the optional route.

Method / explanation: SEBI's 2024 framework retained T+1 and added optional T+0; the 30 October 2025 circular further extended QSB implementation timing.

Trap: The extension did not convert optional same-day settlement into universal real-time settlement.

Q19. Answer: C | Economy

Under Article 112, which statement is correct?

A. The Prime Minister constitutionally lays it before the Lok Sabha alone. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The Prime Minister is not the constitutional actor named in Article 112.

B. It contains only charged expenditure. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The statement includes both charged and other expenditure, not only charged items.

C. The President causes the Annual Financial Statement to be laid before both Houses. - CORRECT: Correct: Article 112 assigns the laying obligation to the President; the Finance Minister presents it in practice on the President's behalf.

D. Its presentation itself appropriates money from the Consolidated Fund. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Appropriation under Article 114 is separately required before withdrawal.

Method / explanation: Article 112 assigns the laying obligation to the President; the Finance Minister presents it in practice on the President's behalf.

Trap: Do not replace the tested rule - The President causes the Annual Financial Statement to be laid before both Houses. - with a neighbouring legal, accounting, vintage or institutional category.

Q20. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement best describes DILRMP?

A. It is solely a crop-insurance programme. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Crop insurance is a different policy field. The option states: It is solely a crop-insurance programme.

B. It abolishes State land departments. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: States remain central implementers. The option states: It abolishes State land departments.

C. It covers only urban stock-exchange property. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The programme concerns land records, not securities markets. The option states: It covers only urban stock-exchange property.

D. It modernises textual and spatial records and their integration; it does not itself guarantee title. - CORRECT: Correct: DILRMP is land-information infrastructure implemented through States and Union Territories. The option states: It modernises textual and spatial records and their integration; it does not itself guarantee title.

Method / explanation: DILRMP is land-information infrastructure implemented through States and Union Territories. The option states: It modernises textual and spatial records and their integration; it does not itself guarantee title.

Trap: Digitisation and conclusive titling are different reforms.

Q21. Answer: A | Economy

Consider the following statements: 1. A secured bond has recourse to specified collateral. 2. A subordinated bond ranks behind senior debt. 3. Every listed bond is sovereign-guaranteed. Which statements are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Security and seniority are separate dimensions, and neither listing nor rating assures repayment.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 also correctly identifies the lower priority of subordinated debt.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 is correct, while exchange listing does not create a sovereign guarantee.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The first two are contractual distinctions; statement 3 invents a guarantee unrelated to listing.

Method / explanation: Security and seniority are separate dimensions, and neither listing nor rating assures repayment.

Trap: Listed, secured, senior and guaranteed are four different attributes.

Q22. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following statements about TREPS: 1. It is a triparty-repo dealing system. 2. A triparty agent supports collateral and settlement services. 3. It is the same unsecured instrument as call money. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 is integral to triparty repo because the third party manages specified collateral and operational functions.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: TREPS is the Indian triparty-repo system, with CCIL supporting central-counterparty clearing and settlement.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 is false because TREPS transactions are collateralised, unlike call money.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The first two are correct, but the unsecured character asserted in statement 3 is incompatible with repo.

Method / explanation: TREPS is the Indian triparty-repo system, with CCIL supporting central-counterparty clearing and settlement.

Trap: The superseded CBLO label may appear in PYQs, but the current market mechanism is TREPS.

Q23. Answer: C | Economy

Which institutional matching is correct?

A. GST Council - monetary policy; Finance Commission - GST invoices; Union Budget - Supreme Court review. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: RBI, tax administrations and courts perform the mismatched functions.

B. GST Council - direct tax assessment; Finance Commission - corporate regulation; Union Budget - State Finance Commission appointments. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: CBDT and State constitutional processes displace the suggested pairings.

C. GST Council - GST recommendations; Finance Commission - devolution and grants; Union Budget - annual fiscal estimates and authorisation process. - CORRECT: Correct: The match preserves each institution's constitutional and operational role.

D. All three are interchangeable rate-setting bodies. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Different constitutional anchors prevent institutional interchangeability.

Method / explanation: The match preserves each institution's constitutional and operational role.

Trap: Name the institution, legal output and implementation route separately.

Q24. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement best defines infrastructure outcome?

A. A sanctioned project list. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Sanction is an administrative stage rather than a user outcome. The option states: A sanctioned project list.

B. Any concrete structure regardless of use. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Physical structure without use or upkeep may be stranded capacity. The option states: Any concrete structure regardless of use.

C. Only private investment in networks. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Infrastructure can be publicly, privately or jointly financed. The option states: Only private investment in networks.

D. A completed, connected, operated and maintained service. - CORRECT: Correct: Service delivery requires completion, connectivity, operation and maintenance. The option states: A completed, connected, operated and maintained service.

Method / explanation: Service delivery requires completion, connectivity, operation and maintenance. The option states: A completed, connected, operated and maintained service.

Trap: Track the project all the way to service.

Q25. Answer: A | Ancient History

Which one of the following is the safest statement regarding Harappan religious interpretation?

A. Figurines, motifs and installations indicate possible ritual practices, but names and doctrines remain unsettled. - CORRECT: Correct: Material objects can show repeated symbols and possible ritual activity. The familiar deity labels and a single uniform creed go beyond the undeciphered archaeological record.

B. The horned seal figure is securely identified as Shiva. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "The horned seal figure is securely identified as Shiva." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that material objects can show repeated symbols and possible ritual activity. The familiar deity labels and a single uniform creed go beyond the undeciphered archaeological record.

C. Fire installations prove a uniform state religion. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Fire installations prove a uniform state religion." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that material objects can show repeated symbols and possible ritual activity. The familiar deity labels and a single uniform creed go beyond the undeciphered archaeological record.

D. Female figurines conclusively prove one Mother Goddess cult. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Female figurines conclusively prove one Mother Goddess cult." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that material objects can show repeated symbols and possible ritual activity. The familiar deity labels and a single uniform creed go beyond the undeciphered archaeological record.

Method / explanation: Material objects can show repeated symbols and possible ritual activity. The familiar deity labels and a single uniform creed go beyond the undeciphered archaeological record.

Trap: Iconography must be described before a later deity-name is proposed.

Q26. Answer: B | Ancient History

Which is the safest historical statement about the Tirthankaras?

A. Rishabhanatha is proven by Harappan seals, as though every school preserved the same chronology and canon. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise Jain chronology benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'Parshvanatha is a plausible pre-Mahavira teacher, while the full sequence is primarily sacred tradition.'. [Q2-A]

B. Parshvanatha is a plausible pre-Mahavira teacher, while the full sequence is primarily sacred tradition. - CORRECT: Correct: Evidence confidence is graded: Mahavira is historical, Parshva plausible, and remote traditional chronology cannot be archaeologically asserted. It matches the tested Jain chronology distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q2-B]

C. All twenty-four are securely dated by inscriptions, treated as a uniform rule across regions and historical phases. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise Jain chronology benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'Parshvanatha is a plausible pre-Mahavira teacher, while the full sequence is primarily sacred tradition.'. [Q2-C]

D. Mahavira was the first Tirthankara, without separating early teaching from later systematisation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It telescopes chronology or attributes a gradual development in Jain chronology to one beginning. [Q2-D]

Method / explanation: Evidence confidence is graded: Mahavira is historical, Parshva plausible, and remote traditional chronology cannot be archaeologically asserted. It matches the tested Jain chronology distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q2-B]

Trap: For Jain chronology, fix the tradition and chronology before accepting a familiar term; question 2 specifically tests the boundary around Parshvanatha is a plausible pre-Mahavira teacher, while the full sequence is primarily sacred tradition.

Q27. Answer: C | Ancient History

Which is the most defensible statement on Buddhism and caste?

A. It admitted no lower-status followers, as though every school preserved the same chronology and canon. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise social access benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'it challenged birth superiority and widened religious access without abolishing caste society.'. [Q22-A]

B. It accepted birth as the sole basis of worth, treated as a uniform rule across regions and historical phases. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise social access benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'it challenged birth superiority and widened religious access without abolishing caste society.'. [Q22-C]

C. It challenged birth superiority and widened religious access without abolishing caste society. - CORRECT: Correct: A nuanced answer distinguishes salvific access from total social revolution. It matches the tested social access distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q22-B]

D. It legally abolished varna in all kingdoms, without separating early teaching from later systematisation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Its absolute wording turns a limited point about social access into a universal claim. [Q22-D]

Method / explanation: A nuanced answer distinguishes salvific access from total social revolution. It matches the tested social access distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q22-B]

Trap: For social access, fix the tradition and chronology before accepting a familiar term; question 22 specifically tests the boundary around It challenged birth superiority and widened religious access without abolishing caste society.

Q28. Answer: D | Ancient History

Which statement best captures provincial assertion in a multi-causal model?

A. All regions waited passively for Pushyamitra's coup. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. "All regions waited passively for Pushyamitra's coup." fails this regional agency test. It asserts direct continuity, uniformity or precision where the surviving archive supports only a qualified inference. Controlling evidence: Regional successor evidence; Sharma pp. 208-211. [Q23-A]

B. Provincial agency rules out any role for frontier invasion. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. "Provincial agency rules out any role for frontier invasion." fails this regional agency test. It collapses distinct dates, processes or evidence classes that the question requires the learner to separate. Controlling evidence: Regional successor evidence; Sharma pp. 208-211. [Q23-B]

C. Regional states had no connection with earlier routes or material culture. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. "Regional states had no connection with earlier routes or material culture." fails this regional agency test. It reverses the chronology or causal direction and therefore fails the source-and-sequence test. Controlling evidence: Regional successor evidence; Sharma pp. 208-211. [Q23-D]

D. Regional elites could redirect revenue, troops and legitimacy when succession and central coordination weakened. - CORRECT: Correct. Regional actors converted structural opportunity into new polities. This mechanism interacts with weak succession, communication costs and frontier pressure rather than replacing them. Named evidence: Regional successor evidence; Sharma pp. 208-211. Qualification: Regions are agents, not empty spaces on an imperial map. [Q23-C]

Method / explanation: Correct. Regional actors converted structural opportunity into new polities. This mechanism interacts with weak succession, communication costs and frontier pressure rather than replacing them. Named evidence: Regional successor evidence; Sharma pp. 208-211. Qualification: Regions are agents, not empty spaces on an imperial map. [Q23-C]

Trap: Regions are agents, not empty spaces on an imperial map.

Q29. Answer: A | Medieval History

With reference to Struggle for Empire: Afghans, Rajputs & Humayun, consider the following statements: 1. Babur left Humayun with weak finances, unconsolidated administration, unsubdued Afghans and the Timurid problem of brothers claiming shares. 2. Kamran's occupation of Lahore and Multan weakened central unity, though Humayun accepted it to avoid civil war and focus east. 3. Humayun ignored Sher Khan from the beginning. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Struggle for Empire: Afghans, Rajputs & Humayun; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He besieged Chunar and moved east, but misread

Sher Khan's strength.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Humayun ignored Sher Khan from the beginning.' and replaces it with 'He besieged Chunar and moved east, but misread Sher Khan's strength.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Humayun ignored Sher Khan from the beginning.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He besieged Chunar and moved east, but misread Sher Khan's strength.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He besieged Chunar and moved east, but misread Sher Khan's strength.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Humayun ignored Sher Khan from the beginning. -> He besieged Chunar and moved east, but misread Sher Khan's strength.

Q30. Answer: B | Medieval History

With reference to Sher Shah Sur & the Sur Empire, consider the following statements: 1. Sher Shah rose from Farid, son of a small jagirdar, to the ruler of the mightiest north Indian empire since Muhammad bin Tughlaq. 2. His empire extended from Bengal to the Indus, excluding Kashmir; in the west he conquered Malwa and almost all Rajasthan. 3. Sher Shah invented the GT Road from nothing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Sher Shah invented the GT Road from nothing.' and replaces it with 'He restored and improved the old imperial road.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Sher Shah Sur & the Sur Empire; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He restored and improved the old imperial road.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Sher Shah invented the GT Road from nothing.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He restored and improved the old imperial road.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He restored and improved the old imperial road.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Sher Shah invented the GT Road from nothing. -> He restored and improved the old imperial road.

Q31. Answer: C | Medieval History

With reference to Akbar: Consolidation & Expansion of the Empire, consider the following statements: 1. Akbar inherited a fragile empire: Afghans were strong, Sikandar Sur was still active, Kabul was threatened, and Hemu captured Agra and Delhi. 2. At Panipat (5 November 1556) Hemu's wounding was a major contingency within a wider contest of command, captured artillery, cavalry/elephants and Mughal-Bairam leadership; army totals remain source claims. 3. Panipat II ended all Afghan resistance immediately. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Panipat II ended all Afghan resistance immediately.' and replaces it with 'Afghans remained active for years, especially in the east.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Panipat II ended all Afghan resistance immediately.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Akbar: Consolidation & Expansion of the Empire; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Afghans remained active for years, especially in the east.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Afghans remained active for years, especially in the east.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Afghans remained active for years, especially in the east.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Panipat II ended all Afghan resistance immediately. -> Afghans remained active for years, especially in the east.

Q32. Answer: D | Medieval History

With reference to State & Government under Akbar (Mansabdari, Dahsala), consider the following statements: 1. Akbar adopted Sher Shah's measured revenue approach but found the central price schedule delayed assessment and hurt peasants when court prices were higher than countryside prices. 2. Around 1580, the dahsala schedule used ten-year produce/price data to frame annual cash rates; the commonly stated one-third norm and actual realization varied by crop,

region and collection. 3. Dahsala meant revenue was fixed permanently for ten years. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Dahsala meant revenue was fixed permanently for ten years.' and replaces it with 'It was based on ten-year average produce/prices; the state could modify it.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Dahsala meant revenue was fixed permanently for ten years.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was based on ten-year average produce/prices; the state could modify it.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about State & Government under Akbar (Mansabdari, Dahsala); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was based on ten-year average produce/prices; the state could modify it.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was based on ten-year average produce/prices; the state could modify it.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Dahsala meant revenue was fixed permanently for ten years. -> It was based on ten-year average produce/prices; the state could modify it.

Q33. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to Gandhi's Rise; Rowlatt & Jallianwala Bagh (1917-1919), consider the following statements: 1. In South Africa, Gandhi organised Indians through the Natal Indian Congress and developed satyagraha, a method based on truth-force, non-violent resistance and willingness to suffer. 2. Gandhi returned to India in 1915, treated Gopal Krishna Gokhale as his political mentor and spent time touring India before launching major campaigns. 3. General Dyer was cleared by Indian opinion. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Gandhi's Rise; Rowlatt & Jallianwala Bagh (1917-1919); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He became a symbol of colonial brutality and Punjab repression.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'General Dyer was cleared by Indian opinion.' and replaces it with 'He became a symbol of colonial brutality and Punjab repression.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: General Dyer was cleared by Indian opinion.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He became a symbol of colonial brutality and Punjab repression.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He became a symbol of colonial brutality and Punjab repression.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: General Dyer was cleared by Indian opinion. -> He became a symbol of colonial brutality and Punjab repression.

Q34. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Non-Cooperation & the Khilafat Movement (1919-1922), consider the following statements: 1. Indian Muslims feared harsh treatment of the Ottoman Sultan-Caliph after World War I and the Treaty of Sevres. 2. The Khilafat leadership included the Ali Brothers (Maulana Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali), Maulana Azad and Hakim Ajmal Khan. 3. Gandhi withdrew because the movement was weak. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Gandhi withdrew because the movement was weak.' and replaces it with 'It was withdrawn because violence violated the non-violent method.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Non-Cooperation & the Khilafat Movement (1919-1922); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was withdrawn because violence violated the non-violent method.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Gandhi withdrew because the movement was weak.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was withdrawn because violence violated the non-violent method.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was withdrawn because violence violated the non-violent method.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Gandhi withdrew because the movement was weak. -> It was withdrawn because violence violated the non-violent method.

Q35. Answer: C | Modern History

With reference to Swarajists & Revolutionaries of the 1920s, consider the following statements: 1. After Gandhi withdrew Non-Cooperation, Congress leaders split between No-changers and Pro-changers. 2. No-changers emphasised constructive work: khadi, national schools, Hindu-Muslim unity and removal of untouchability. 3. HRA and HSRA were identical in ideology. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'HRA and HSRA were identical in ideology.' and replaces it with 'HSRA signalled a clearer socialist republican orientation.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: HRA and HSRA were identical in ideology.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Swarajists & Revolutionaries of the 1920s; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: HSRA signalled a clearer socialist republican orientation.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: HSRA signalled a clearer socialist republican orientation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: HSRA signalled a clearer socialist republican orientation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: HRA and HSRA were identical in ideology. -> HSRA signalled a clearer socialist republican orientation.

Q36. Answer: D | Modern History

With reference to Simon, Nehru Report, Civil Disobedience & Round Table Conferences, consider the following statements: 1. The Simon Commission was appointed in 1927 and reached India in 1928 without any Indian member. 2. The boycott slogan "Simon Go Back" turned the Commission into a nationwide anti-imperialist issue across parties and regions. 3. Poona Pact accepted separate electorates for Depressed Classes. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Poona Pact accepted separate electorates for Depressed Classes.' and replaces it with 'It replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Poona Pact accepted separate electorates for Depressed Classes.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Simon, Nehru Report, Civil Disobedience & Round Table Conferences; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Poona Pact accepted separate electorates for Depressed Classes. -> It replaced separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates.

Q37. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to Left, Peasant, Workers' & States' Peoples' Movements, consider the following statements: 1. The rise of the Left in the 1930s reflected the influence of socialist ideas on leaders such as Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose. 2. The Congress Socialist Party (1934) was formed within Congress by leaders including Jayaprakash Narayan, Acharya Narendra Dev, Ram Manohar Lohia and Minoo Masani. 3. Moplah was either only agrarian or only communal. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Left, Peasant, Workers' & States' Peoples' Movements; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It began in an agrarian and anti-colonial setting but included communal violence; both dimensions must be stated.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Moplah was either only agrarian or only communal.' and replaces it with 'It began in an agrarian and anti-colonial setting but included communal violence; both dimensions must be stated.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Moplah was either only agrarian or only communal.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It began in an agrarian and anti-colonial setting but included communal violence; both dimensions must be stated.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It began in an agrarian and anti-colonial setting but included communal violence; both dimensions must be stated.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Moplah was either only agrarian or only communal. -> It began in an agrarian and anti-colonial setting but included communal violence; both dimensions must be stated.

Q38. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to The Government of India Act 1935 & the Congress Ministries, consider the following statements: 1. The Government of India Act 1935 drew on the Simon Report, Round Table Conferences, the 1933 White Paper and Joint Select Committee work. 2. It proposed an All-India Federation of British Indian provinces and princely states, but the federation never came into being because the princes did not accede. 3. The All-India Federation came into being in 1937. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The All-India Federation came into being in 1937.' and replaces it with 'It never came into being because princely states did not accede.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Government of India Act 1935 & the Congress Ministries; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It never came into being because princely states did not accede.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The All-India Federation came into being in 1937.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It never came into being because princely states did not accede.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It never came into being because princely states did not accede.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The All-India Federation came into being in 1937. -> It never came into being because princely states did not accede.

Q39. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement best expresses the limit of GI protection?

A. GI status automatically guarantees artisan income and ecological sustainability. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the legal layer is narrower than total safeguarding. The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument. The option tested was 'GI status automatically guarantees artisan income and ecological sustainability.'

B. GI status is the same as UNESCO heritage status. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument. The option tested was 'GI status is the same as UNESCO heritage status.'

C. A GI protects an origin-linked product name for authorised users, but does not by itself secure wages, raw materials or skill transmission. - CORRECT: Correct: the legal layer is narrower than total safeguarding. The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument. The option tested was 'A GI protects an origin-linked product name for authorised users, but does not by itself secure wages, raw materials or skill transmission.'

D. GI status means the product can only be studied as law, not as culture. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the legal layer is narrower than total safeguarding. The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument. The option tested was 'GI status means the product can only be studied as law, not as culture.'

Method / explanation: the legal layer is narrower than total safeguarding. The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument. The option tested was 'A GI protects an origin-linked product name for authorised users, but does not by itself secure wages, raw materials or skill transmission.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q40. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement about Maratha Military Landscapes of India is safest?

A. It is one isolated fort and not a serial property. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: UNESCO describes it as a serial fort network. The option tested was 'It is one isolated fort and not a serial property.'

B. It is India's latest ICH inscription. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: UNESCO describes it as a serial fort network. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It is India's latest ICH inscription.'

C. It replaced Moidams in the danger list. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: UNESCO describes it as a serial fort network. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It replaced Moidams in the danger list.'

D. It is a serial World Heritage inscription of twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu. - CORRECT: Correct: UNESCO describes it as a serial fort network. The option tested was 'It is a serial World Heritage inscription of twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu.'

Method / explanation: UNESCO describes it as a serial fort network. The option tested was 'It is a serial World Heritage inscription of twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q41. Answer: A | Art and Culture

Which statement best captures IGNCA's role?

A. It is a multidisciplinary resource centre for written, oral and visual materials, research and dissemination in the arts. - CORRECT: Correct: IGNCA's official page emphasises multidisciplinary arts research and documentation. The option tested was 'It is a multidisciplinary resource centre for written, oral and visual materials, research and dissemination in the arts.'

B. It is only a field-excavation wing of ASI. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: IGNCA's official page emphasises multidisciplinary arts research and documentation. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It is only a field-excavation wing of ASI.'

C. It is the statutory authority for prohibited-area construction permission. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: IGNCA's official page emphasises multidisciplinary arts research and documentation. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It is the statutory authority for prohibited-area construction permission.'

D. It is only a tourism-ticketing portal. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: IGNCA's official page emphasises multidisciplinary arts research and documentation. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It is only a tourism-ticketing portal.'

Method / explanation: IGNCA's official page emphasises multidisciplinary arts research and documentation. The option tested was 'It is a multidisciplinary resource centre for written, oral and visual materials, research and dissemination in the arts.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q42. Answer: B | Art and Culture

Which statement about Hindi's literary rise is safest?

A. Hindi was the official language of the Mauryan empire under Article 343. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the keyed statement captures Hindi's long emergence through Apabhramsha and its later literary expansion through Bhakti. The option tested was 'Hindi was the official language of the Mauryan empire under Article 343.'

B. Hindi emerged through a long process involving Apabhramsha and received major literary momentum through Bhakti. - CORRECT: Correct: the keyed statement captures Hindi's long emergence through Apabhramsha and its later literary expansion through Bhakti. The option tested was 'Hindi emerged through a long process involving Apabhramsha and received major literary momentum through Bhakti.'

C. Hindi has no relation to Prakrit or Apabhramsha in the source bank. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the keyed statement captures Hindi's long emergence through Apabhramsha and its later literary expansion through Bhakti. The option tested was 'Hindi has no relation to Prakrit or Apabhramsha in the source bank.'

D. Hindi literature began only after electronic media. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the keyed statement captures Hindi's long emergence through Apabhramsha and its later literary expansion through Bhakti. The option tested was 'Hindi literature began only after electronic media.'

Method / explanation: the keyed statement captures Hindi's long emergence through Apabhramsha and its later literary expansion through Bhakti. The option tested was 'Hindi emerged through a long process involving Apabhramsha and received major literary momentum through Bhakti.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q43. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement is safest about NMMA?

A. It is a theatre-training institution set up by Sangeet Natak Akademi. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: NMMA focuses on registers and documentation. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It

is a theatre-training institution set up by Sangeet Natak Akademi.'.

B. It issues GI tags for crafts. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: NMMA focuses on registers and documentation. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It issues GI tags for crafts.'.

C. It is the mission launched to document monuments and antiquities through national registers and databases. - CORRECT: Correct: NMMA focuses on registers and documentation. The option tested was 'It is the mission launched to document monuments and antiquities through national registers and databases.'.

D. It is a UNESCO category for documentary heritage. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It is a UNESCO category for documentary heritage.'.

Method / explanation: NMMA focuses on registers and documentation. The option tested was 'It is the mission launched to document monuments and antiquities through national registers and databases.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q44. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement is safest about Indian colour-film milestones?

A. Kisan Kanya was the first talkie and Sairandhri the first studio-system film. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the prelims trap lies in keeping the 1933 colour-processing milestone separate from the 1937 indigenous-colour one. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline. The option tested was 'Kisan Kanya was the first talkie and Sairandhri the first studio-system film.'.

B. Both Sairandhri and Kisan Kanya refer to the same milestone and may be used interchangeably. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the prelims trap lies in keeping the 1933 colour-processing milestone separate from the 1937 indigenous-colour one. The option tested was 'Both Sairandhri and Kisan Kanya refer to the same milestone and may be used interchangeably.'.

C. Neither film has any place in Indian cinema chronology. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline. The option tested was 'Neither film has any place in Indian cinema chronology.'.

D. Sairandhri (1933) was the first Indian colour film, while Kisan Kanya (1937) was the first indigenously made colour film. - CORRECT: Correct: the prelims trap lies in keeping the 1933 colour-processing milestone separate from the 1937 indigenous-colour one. The option tested was 'Sairandhri (1933) was the first Indian colour film, while Kisan Kanya (1937) was the first indigenously made colour film.'.

Method / explanation: the prelims trap lies in keeping the 1933 colour-processing milestone separate from the 1937 indigenous-colour one. The option tested was 'Sairandhri (1933) was the first Indian colour film, while Kisan Kanya (1937) was the first indigenously made colour film.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q45. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Cultural and Social Geography: Concepts, Regions, Language & Religion, consider the following statements: 1. Language and religion are major cultural-region markers. 2. Cultural regions can cross political boundaries. 3. Linguistic geography is only about one majority language. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Cultural and Social Geography: Concepts, Regions, Language & Religion; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: transition zones and minority pockets are equally important.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Linguistic geography is only about one majority language.' and replaces it with 'transition zones and minority pockets are equally important.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Linguistic geography is only about one majority language.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: transition zones and minority pockets are equally important.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: transition zones and minority pockets are equally important.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Linguistic geography is only about one majority language. -> transition zones and minority pockets are equally important.

Q46. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to The Earth and the Universe, consider the following statements: 1. only the outer core is liquid. 2. Only the outer core is liquid (S-wave proof); inner core is solid. 3. The whole core is molten. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'only the outer core is liquid.'
- B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.
- C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'only the outer core is liquid.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'The whole core is molten.' with 'only the outer core is liquid.'. It separately supports statement 2: Only the outer core is liquid (S-wave proof); inner core is solid.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The whole core is molten. -> only the outer core is liquid.

Q47. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to The Earth's Crust Rocks, consider the following statements: 1. Fracturing, jointing and weathering often control secondary permeability more than the unfractured rock matrix. 2. Sedimentary rocks are stratified (layered) - usually deposited under water; layers vary from inches to many feet. 3. Metamorphic-rock permeability is fixed by rock name alone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Fracturing, jointing and weathering often control secondary permeability more than the unfractured rock matrix.'
- B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Fracturing, jointing and weathering often control secondary permeability more than the unfractured rock matrix.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Metamorphic-rock permeability is fixed by rock name alone.' with 'Fracturing, jointing and weathering often control secondary permeability more than the unfractured rock matrix.'. It separately supports statement 2: Sedimentary rocks are stratified (layered) - usually deposited under water; layers vary from inches to many feet.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Metamorphic-rock permeability is fixed by rock name alone. -> Fracturing, jointing and weathering often control secondary permeability more than the unfractured rock matrix.

Q48. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Vulcanism and Earthquakes, consider the following statements: 1. Each whole number = 10x wave amplitude and ~31.5x energy - not double. 2. Distribution of earthquakes coincides closely with volcanoes - both cluster along the same belts. 3. A one-point rise on Richter doubles the energy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Each whole number = 10x wave amplitude and ~31.5x energy - not double.'
- B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Each whole number = 10x wave amplitude and ~31.5x energy - not double.'
- D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'A one-point rise on Richter doubles the energy.' with 'Each whole number = 10x wave amplitude and ~31.5x energy - not double.'. It separately supports statement 2: Distribution of earthquakes coincides closely with volcanoes - both cluster along the same belts.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A one-point rise on Richter doubles the energy. -> Each whole number = 10x wave amplitude and ~31.5x energy - not double.

Q49. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Weathering, Mass Movement & Groundwater, consider the following statements: 1. Soil creep is SLOW/imperceptible; landslides are the rapid form of mass movement. 2. Mass movement = down-slope movement of weathered material under gravity; speed depends on slope gradient, debris weight and rain lubrication. 3. Soil creep is a rapid, visible movement. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Soil creep is SLOW/imperceptible; landslides are the rapid form of mass movement.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Soil creep is SLOW/imperceptible; landslides are the rapid form of mass movement.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Soil creep is a rapid, visible movement.' with 'Soil creep is SLOW/imperceptible; landslides are the rapid form of mass movement.'. It separately supports statement 2: Mass movement = down-slope movement of weathered material under gravity; speed depends on slope gradient, debris weight and rain lubrication.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Soil creep is a rapid, visible movement. -> Soil creep is SLOW/imperceptible; landslides are the rapid form of mass movement.

Q50. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Landforms by Running Water, consider the following statements: 1. Vertical corrasion (erosion) dominates the upper course; deposition dominates the LOWER course. 2. Lower course: heavy with debris, work is mainly deposition - building flood plains; cut-off meanders become ox-bow lakes; sediment builds natural levees. 3. Deposition dominates the upper course. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Vertical corrasion (erosion) dominates the upper course; deposition dominates the LOWER course.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Vertical corrasion (erosion) dominates the upper course; deposition dominates the LOWER course.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Deposition dominates the upper course.' with 'Vertical corrasion (erosion) dominates the upper course; deposition dominates the LOWER course.'. It separately supports statement 2: Lower course: heavy with debris, work is mainly deposition - building flood plains; cut-off meanders become ox-bow lakes; sediment builds natural levees.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Deposition dominates the upper course. -> Vertical corrasion (erosion) dominates the upper course; deposition dominates the LOWER course.

Q51. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Landforms of Glaciation, consider the following statements: 1. Rivers make V-shaped valleys; glaciers carve U-shaped troughs. 2. U-shaped valley (glacial trough): the glacier grinds a former V-valley into a broad, steep-sided U; tributary valleys are left as hanging valleys (waterfalls). 3. U-shaped valleys are made by rivers. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Rivers make V-shaped valleys; glaciers carve U-shaped troughs.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Rivers make V-shaped valleys; glaciers carve U-shaped troughs.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'U-shaped valleys are made by rivers.' with 'Rivers make V-shaped valleys; glaciers carve U-shaped troughs.'. It separately supports statement 2: U-shaped valley (glacial trough): the glacier grinds a former V-valley into a broad, steep-sided U; tributary valleys are left as hanging valleys (waterfalls).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: U-shaped valleys are made by rivers. -> Rivers make V-shaped valleys; glaciers carve U-shaped troughs.

Q52. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Arid Desert Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Barchan horns point DOWNWIND (leeward); the gentle slope faces the wind. 2. Ventifacts are wind-faceted pebbles; a three-faced one is a dreikanter. Inselbergs are isolated residual hills. Mesas and buttes are structurally controlled residuals shaped by combined weathering, runoff and slope retreat-not wind-only forms. 3. Barchan horns point into (upwind of) the wind. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Barchan horns point DOWNWIND (leeward); the gentle slope faces the wind.'
- B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Barchan horns point DOWNWIND (leeward); the gentle slope faces the wind.'
- D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Barchan horns point into (upwind of) the wind.' with 'Barchan horns point DOWNWIND (leeward); the gentle slope faces the wind.'. It separately supports statement 2: Ventifacts are wind-faceted pebbles; a three-faced one is a dreikanter. Inselbergs are isolated residual hills. Mesas and buttes are structurally controlled residuals shaped by combined weathering, runoff and slope retreat-not wind-only forms.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Barchan horns point into (upwind of) the wind. -> Barchan horns point DOWNWIND (leeward); the gentle slope faces the wind.

Q53. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Limestone and Karst Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Stalactites hang from the ROOF; stalagmites rise from the FLOOR. 2. Clints & grikes (limestone pavement): blocks (clints) separated by solution-widened joints (grikes); French term for karren is lapies. 3. Stalagmites hang from the cave roof. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Stalactites hang from the ROOF; stalagmites rise from the FLOOR.'
- C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Stalactites hang from the ROOF; stalagmites rise from the FLOOR.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Stalagmites hang from the cave roof.' with 'Stalactites hang from the ROOF; stalagmites rise from the FLOOR.'. It separately supports statement 2: Clints & grikes (limestone pavement): blocks (clints) separated by solution-widened joints (grikes); French term for karren is lapies.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Stalagmites hang from the cave roof. -> Stalactites hang from the ROOF; stalagmites rise from the FLOOR.

Q54. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Lakes: Formation & Types, consider the following statements: 1. It is a brackish coastal lagoon (depositional), mixing river and sea water. 2. Rift-valley lakes are tectonic and very deep: Tanganyika, Baikal. 3. Chilika is a freshwater tectonic lake. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is a brackish coastal lagoon (depositional), mixing river and sea water.'
- B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.
- C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is a brackish coastal lagoon (depositional), mixing river and sea water.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Chilika is a freshwater tectonic lake.' with 'It is a brackish coastal lagoon (depositional), mixing river and sea water.'. It separately supports statement 2: Rift-valley lakes are tectonic and very deep: Tanganyika, Baikal.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Chilika is a freshwater tectonic lake. -> It is a brackish coastal lagoon (depositional), mixing river and sea water.

Q55. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Coastal Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Hard structures often shift erosion downdrift by disrupting longshore drift. 2. Longshore drift builds spits, bars and tombolos. 3. Seawalls always stop coastal erosion everywhere. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Hard structures often shift erosion downdrift by disrupting longshore drift.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Hard structures often shift erosion downdrift by disrupting longshore drift.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Seawalls always stop coastal erosion everywhere.' with 'Hard structures often shift erosion downdrift by disrupting longshore drift.'. It separately supports statement 2: Longshore drift builds spits, bars and tombolos.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Seawalls always stop coastal erosion everywhere. -> Hard structures often shift erosion downdrift by disrupting longshore drift.

Q56. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Islands & Coral Reefs, consider the following statements: 1. Coral islands are generally low; volcanic islands are high. 2. Coral needs warm, shallow, sunlit, clear and normally saline water; local species tolerances vary. 3. Coral islands are high and rugged. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Coral islands are generally low; volcanic islands are high.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Coral islands are generally low; volcanic islands are high.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Coral islands are high and rugged.' with 'Coral islands are generally low; volcanic islands are high.'. It separately supports statement 2: Coral needs warm, shallow, sunlit, clear and normally saline water; local species tolerances vary.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Coral islands are high and rugged. -> Coral islands are generally low; volcanic islands are high.

Q57. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species, consider the following statements: 1. Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU. 2. India hosted CMS CoP13 in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, in 2020, and subsequently held the CMS Presidency. 3. A species must be on either Appendix I or Appendix II, never both. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'A species must be on either Appendix I or Appendix II, never both.' with 'Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU.'. It separately supports statement 2: India hosted CMS CoP13 in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, in 2020, and subsequently

held the CMS Presidency.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A species must be on either Appendix I or Appendix II, never both. -> Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU.

Q58. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Forest Types and Forest Rights Act, consider the following statements: 1. It recognises specific rights of forest dwellers within the broader framework of forest governance, rather than transferring full ownership/control away from the state. 2. The Act provides for Individual Forest Rights, Community Rights and Community Forest Resource rights as distinct categories. 3. The Forest Rights Act removes all state authority over forest land. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It recognises specific rights of forest dwellers within the broader framework of forest governance, rather than transferring full ownership/control away from the state.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It recognises specific rights of forest dwellers within the broader framework of forest governance, rather than transferring full ownership/control away from the state.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'The Forest Rights Act removes all state authority over forest land.' with 'It recognises specific rights of forest dwellers within the broader framework of forest governance, rather than transferring full ownership/control away from the state.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Act provides for Individual Forest Rights, Community Rights and Community Forest Resource rights as distinct categories.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Forest Rights Act removes all state authority over forest land. -> It recognises specific rights of forest dwellers within the broader framework of forest governance, rather than transferring full ownership/control away from the state.

Q59. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission, consider the following statements: 1. CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams. 2. The Green India Mission is one of the eight original missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC); the Government now describes NAPCC as operating through nine missions, with health added. 3. CAMPA and the Green India Mission are the same programme. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'CAMPA and the Green India Mission are the same programme.' with 'CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Green India Mission is one of the eight original missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC); the Government now describes NAPCC as operating through nine missions, with health added.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: CAMPA and the Green India Mission are the same programme. -> CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams.

Q60. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Air Pollution and CPCB Standards, consider the following statements: 1. It results from a combination of vehicular, industrial, construction, biomass-burning and meteorological factors. 2. NCAP was launched in 2019 to reduce particulate-matter pollution in identified non-attainment cities through time-bound targets. 3. Air pollution in Delhi-NCR is caused only by vehicular emissions. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It results from a combination of vehicular, industrial, construction, biomass-burning and meteorological factors.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It results from a combination of vehicular, industrial, construction, biomass-burning and meteorological factors.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Air pollution in Delhi-NCR is caused only by vehicular emissions.' with 'It results from a combination of vehicular, industrial, construction, biomass-burning and meteorological factors.'. It separately supports statement 2: NCAP was launched in 2019 to reduce particulate-matter pollution in identified non-attainment cities through time-bound targets.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Air pollution in Delhi-NCR is caused only by vehicular emissions. -> It results from a combination of vehicular, industrial, construction, biomass-burning and meteorological factors.

Q61. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Water Pollution and River Cleaning Missions, consider the following statements: 1. It was a declaratory, priority-signalling status, not a new statutory regime. 2. The Namami Gange Programme is implemented by the National Mission for Clean Ganga under the Ministry of Jal Shakti. 3. Declaring the Ganga a "National River" (2008) created a new legal protection category. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It was a declaratory, priority-signalling status, not a new statutory regime.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It was a declaratory, priority-signalling status, not a new statutory regime.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Declaring the Ganga a "National River" (2008) created a new legal protection category.' with 'It was a declaratory, priority-signalling status, not a new statutory regime.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Namami Gange Programme is implemented by the National Mission for Clean Ganga under the Ministry of Jal Shakti.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Declaring the Ganga a "National River" (2008) created a new legal protection category. -> It was a declaratory, priority-signalling status, not a new statutory regime.

Q62. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Solid Plastic and E-Waste Rules, consider the following statements: 1. A significant share has historically been processed through informal, often environmentally unsafe channels, which the 2022 Rules aim to shift toward authorised recycling. 2. The Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 mandate source segregation into wet, dry and hazardous/domestic-hazardous categories. 3. E-waste in India is primarily managed through formal, authorised recyclers today. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'A significant share has historically been processed through informal, often environmentally unsafe channels, which the 2022 Rules aim to shift toward authorised recycling.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'A significant share has historically been processed through informal, often environmentally unsafe channels, which the 2022 Rules aim to shift toward authorised recycling.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'E-waste in India is primarily managed through formal, authorised recyclers today.' with 'A significant share has historically been processed through informal, often environmentally unsafe channels, which the 2022 Rules aim to shift toward authorised recycling.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 mandate source segregation into wet, dry and hazardous/domestic-hazardous categories.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: E-waste in India is primarily managed through formal, authorised recyclers today. -> A significant share has historically been processed through informal, often environmentally unsafe channels, which the 2022 Rules aim to shift toward authorised recycling.

Q63. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT, consider the following statements: 1. It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories. 2. The National Green Tribunal was established under the National Green Tribunal Act, 2010, for speedy and specialised disposal of environmental cases. 3. Public consultation is mandatory for every category of project under the EIA Notification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Public consultation is mandatory for every category of project under the EIA Notification.' with 'It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories.'. It separately supports statement 2: The National Green Tribunal was established under the National Green Tribunal Act, 2010, for speedy and specialised disposal of environmental cases.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Public consultation is mandatory for every category of project under the EIA Notification. -> It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories.

Q64. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Climate Change Science Greenhouse Effect, consider the following statements: 1. Global warming refers specifically to temperature rise; climate change is the broader term encompassing warming plus its downstream weather-pattern effects. 2. Methane has a higher Global Warming Potential than CO₂ over short timeframes but a much shorter atmospheric lifetime. 3. Global warming and climate change are identical, interchangeable terms with no distinction. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Global warming refers specifically to temperature rise; climate change is the broader term encompassing warming plus its downstream weather-pattern effects.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Global warming refers specifically to temperature rise; climate change is the broader term encompassing warming plus its downstream weather-pattern effects.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Global warming and climate change are identical, interchangeable terms with no distinction.' with 'Global warming refers specifically to temperature rise; climate change is the broader term encompassing warming plus its downstream weather-pattern effects.'. It separately supports statement 2: Methane has a higher Global Warming Potential than CO₂ over short timeframes but a much shorter atmospheric lifetime.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Global warming and climate change are identical, interchangeable terms with no distinction. -> Global warming refers specifically to temperature rise; climate change is the broader term encompassing warming plus its downstream weather-pattern effects.

Q65. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to IPCC Assessment Reports, consider the following statements: 1. It has three distinct Working Groups (science, impacts/adaptation, mitigation) plus a Synthesis Report. 2. The IPCC does not conduct its own original research;

it assesses and synthesises existing published scientific literature. 3. The IPCC has only one working group covering all climate topics. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It has three distinct Working Groups (science, impacts/adaptation, mitigation) plus a Synthesis Report.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It has three distinct Working Groups (science, impacts/adaptation, mitigation) plus a Synthesis Report.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'The IPCC has only one working group covering all climate topics.' with 'It has three distinct Working Groups (science, impacts/adaptation, mitigation) plus a Synthesis Report.'. It separately supports statement 2: The IPCC does not conduct its own original research; it assesses and synthesises existing published scientific literature.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The IPCC has only one working group covering all climate topics. -> It has three distinct Working Groups (science, impacts/adaptation, mitigation) plus a Synthesis Report.

Q66. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to UNFCCC COP Kyoto Paris Agreement, consider the following statements: 1. Binding targets applied only to developed (Annex I) countries; developing countries had no binding targets under Kyoto. 2. The Paris Agreement (2015, adopted at COP21) is universally applicable, based on self-determined Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), with a binding process (not binding numeric target) obligation. 3. The Kyoto Protocol applied binding targets to all countries including India and China. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Binding targets applied only to developed (Annex I) countries; developing countries had no binding targets under Kyoto.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Binding targets applied only to developed (Annex I) countries; developing countries had no binding targets under Kyoto.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'The Kyoto Protocol applied binding targets to all countries including India and China.' with 'Binding targets applied only to developed (Annex I) countries; developing countries had no binding targets under Kyoto.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Paris Agreement (2015, adopted at COP21) is universally applicable, based on self-determined Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), with a binding process (not binding numeric target) obligation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Kyoto Protocol applied binding targets to all countries including India and China. -> Binding targets applied only to developed (Annex I) countries; developing countries had no binding targets under Kyoto.

Q67. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to India Climate Policy NAPCC Panchamrit LTLEDS, consider the following statements: 1. Only two were - the 45% emissions-intensity cut by 2030 from 2005 and about 50% non-fossil installed capacity by 2030. 2. India submitted its Long-Term Low-Emission Development Strategy (LT-LEDS) to the UNFCCC in 2022, operationalising the net-zero-by-2070 pathway. 3. All five Panchamrit pledges are quantified targets in India's updated NDC. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Only two were - the 45% emissions-intensity cut by 2030 from 2005 and about 50% non-fossil installed capacity by 2030.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Only two were - the 45% emissions-intensity cut by 2030 from 2005 and about 50% non-fossil installed capacity by 2030.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'All five Panchamrit pledges are quantified targets in India's updated NDC.' with 'Only two were - the 45% emissions-intensity cut by 2030 from 2005 and about 50% non-fossil installed capacity

by 2030.'. It separately supports statement 2: India submitted its Long-Term Low-Emission Development Strategy (LT-LEDS) to the UNFCCC in 2022, operationalising the net-zero-by-2070 pathway.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All five Panchamrit pledges are quantified targets in India's updated NDC. -> Only two were - the 45% emissions-intensity cut by 2030 from 2005 and about 50% non-fossil installed capacity by 2030.

Q68. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Carbon Markets CCUS and Direct Air Capture, consider the following statements: 1. Carbon markets provide a price incentive; actual decarbonisation of hard-to-abate sectors also requires technologies like CCUS, green hydrogen and process innovation. 2. Direct Air Capture is generally more energy-intensive per tonne of CO₂ captured than CCUS, due to the much lower concentration of CO₂ in ambient air compared to industrial flue gas. 3. Carbon markets alone can fully decarbonise hard-to-abate sectors without any technological intervention. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Carbon markets provide a price incentive; actual decarbonisation of hard-to-abate sectors also requires technologies like CCUS, green hydrogen and process innovation.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Carbon markets provide a price incentive; actual decarbonisation of hard-to-abate sectors also requires technologies like CCUS, green hydrogen and process innovation.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Carbon markets alone can fully decarbonise hard-to-abate sectors without any technological intervention.' with 'Carbon markets provide a price incentive; actual decarbonisation of hard-to-abate sectors also requires technologies like CCUS, green hydrogen and process innovation.'. It separately supports statement 2: Direct Air Capture is generally more energy-intensive per tonne of CO₂ captured than CCUS, due to the much lower concentration of CO₂ in ambient air compared to industrial flue gas.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Carbon markets alone can fully decarbonise hard-to-abate sectors without any technological intervention. -> Carbon markets provide a price incentive; actual decarbonisation of hard-to-abate sectors also requires technologies like CCUS, green hydrogen and process innovation.

Q69. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Defence R&D, DRDO and Missile Systems, consider the following statements: 1. The official vocabulary ladder is developmental trial -> user evaluation -> "ready for induction" -> contract -> induction -> deployment. UPSC rewards using the exact rung. 2. The MSS cluster page says the cluster handles missiles and strategic systems required for deterrence and defence. 3. A successful test means the weapon is in service. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'The official vocabulary ladder is developmental trial -> user evaluation -> "ready for induction" -> contract -> induction -> deployment. UPSC rewards using the exact rung.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'The official vocabulary ladder is developmental trial -> user evaluation -> "ready for induction" -> contract -> induction -> deployment. UPSC rewards using the exact rung.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'A successful test means the weapon is in service.' with 'The official vocabulary ladder is developmental trial -> user evaluation -> "ready for induction" -> contract -> induction -> deployment. UPSC rewards using the exact rung.'. It separately supports statement 2: The MSS cluster page says the cluster handles missiles and strategic systems required for deterrence and defence.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A successful test means the weapon is in service. -> The official vocabulary ladder is developmental trial -> user evaluation -> "ready for induction" -> contract -> induction -> deployment. UPSC rewards using the exact rung.

Q70. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Defence Indigenization, Atmanirbhar and Procurement, consider the following statements: 1. It is a procurement and localisation tool, not proof of full supply-chain autonomy. 2. Under the Buy scheme, DAP 2020 recognises Buy (Indian-IDD), Buy (Indian), Buy & Make (Indian), Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) and Buy (Global), in descending order of indigenisation preference. 3. A positive indigenisation list proves complete self-reliance in every component. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is a procurement and localisation tool, not proof of full supply-chain autonomy.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is a procurement and localisation tool, not proof of full supply-chain autonomy.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'A positive indigenisation list proves complete self-reliance in every component.' with 'It is a procurement and localisation tool, not proof of full supply-chain autonomy.'. It separately supports statement 2: Under the Buy scheme, DAP 2020 recognises Buy (Indian-IDD), Buy (Indian), Buy & Make (Indian), Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) and Buy (Global), in descending order of indigenisation preference.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A positive indigenisation list proves complete self-reliance in every component. -> It is a procurement and localisation tool, not proof of full supply-chain autonomy.

Q71. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Digital India and India Stack, UPI, Aadhaar, consider the following statements: 1. Aadhaar is an identity/authentication ecosystem run by UIDAI under the Aadhaar Act; UPI is a payment rail run by NPCI within the RBI-regulated payments ecosystem. 2. RBI's AA Master Direction says an Account Aggregator is an NBFC framework for retrieving, consolidating and presenting financial information under customer consent. 3. Aadhaar and UPI are the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Aadhaar is an identity/authentication ecosystem run by UIDAI under the Aadhaar Act; UPI is a payment rail run by NPCI within the RBI-regulated payments ecosystem.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Aadhaar is an identity/authentication ecosystem run by UIDAI under the Aadhaar Act; UPI is a payment rail run by NPCI within the RBI-regulated payments ecosystem.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Aadhaar and UPI are the same thing.' with 'Aadhaar is an identity/authentication ecosystem run by UIDAI under the Aadhaar Act; UPI is a payment rail run by NPCI within the RBI-regulated payments ecosystem.'. It separately supports statement 2: RBI's AA Master Direction says an Account Aggregator is an NBFC framework for retrieving, consolidating and presenting financial information under customer consent.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Aadhaar and UPI are the same thing. -> Aadhaar is an identity/authentication ecosystem run by UIDAI under the Aadhaar Act; UPI is a payment rail run by NPCI within the RBI-regulated payments ecosystem.

Q72. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Artificial Intelligence, Governance and IndiaAI, consider the following statements: 1. India's official language stresses a balanced, India-specific and innovation-friendly approach. 2. The EU AI Act overview page describes a risk-based approach with different levels of risk and obligations. 3. AI governance means India has chosen a blanket restrictive regime like every other jurisdiction. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'India's official language stresses a balanced, India-specific and innovation-friendly approach.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'India's official language stresses a balanced, India-specific and innovation-friendly approach.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'AI governance means India has chosen a blanket restrictive regime like every other jurisdiction.' with 'India's official language stresses a balanced, India-specific and innovation-friendly approach.'. It separately supports statement 2: The EU AI Act overview page describes a risk-based approach with different levels of risk and obligations.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: AI governance means India has chosen a blanket restrictive regime like every other jurisdiction. -> India's official language stresses a balanced, India-specific and innovation-friendly approach.

Q73. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to National Quantum Mission and Quantum Tech, consider the following statements: 1. Computing is about processing; communication is about secure information exchange/key distribution. 2. DST's T-Hub announcement page names IISc Bengaluru, IIT Madras with C-DOT, IIT Bombay and IIT Delhi as the four hub institutions. 3. Quantum computing and quantum communication mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Computing is about processing; communication is about secure information exchange/key distribution.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Computing is about processing; communication is about secure information exchange/key distribution.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Quantum computing and quantum communication mean the same thing.' with 'Computing is about processing; communication is about secure information exchange/key distribution.'. It separately supports statement 2: DST's T-Hub announcement page names IISc Bengaluru, IIT Madras with C-DOT, IIT Bombay and IIT Delhi as the four hub institutions.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Quantum computing and quantum communication mean the same thing. -> Computing is about processing; communication is about secure information exchange/key distribution.

Q74. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Semiconductor Mission and Electronics Manufacturing, consider the following statements: 1. Design creates the chip blueprint, fabrication makes the wafer, and ATMP/OSAT handles back-end assembly and testing. 2. The DLI scheme is about strengthening the chip design ecosystem, not about building wafer fabs directly. 3. Chip design, fabrication and ATMP mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Design creates the chip blueprint, fabrication makes the wafer, and ATMP/OSAT handles back-end assembly and testing.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Design creates the chip blueprint, fabrication makes the wafer, and ATMP/OSAT handles back-end assembly and testing.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Chip design, fabrication and ATMP mean the same thing.' with 'Design creates the chip blueprint, fabrication makes the wafer, and ATMP/OSAT handles back-end assembly and testing.'. It separately supports statement 2: The DLI scheme is about strengthening the chip design ecosystem, not about building wafer fabs directly.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Chip design, fabrication and ATMP mean the same thing. -> Design creates the chip blueprint, fabrication makes the wafer, and ATMP/OSAT handles back-end assembly and testing.

Q75. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Data Protection, DPDP Act and Cybersecurity, consider the following statements: 1. It may involve both privacy compliance and cybersecurity response, but these are different domains. 2. SDF status depends on factors like volume/sensitivity of data, risk to rights, sovereignty, electoral democracy, security of State and public order - it is a notified

status, not an automatic one. 3. A data breach is only a privacy issue. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It may involve both privacy compliance and cybersecurity response, but these are different domains.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It may involve both privacy compliance and cybersecurity response, but these are different domains.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'A data breach is only a privacy issue.' with 'It may involve both privacy compliance and cybersecurity response, but these are different domains.'. It separately supports statement 2: SDF status depends on factors like volume/sensitivity of data, risk to rights, sovereignty, electoral democracy, security of State and public order - it is a notified status, not an automatic one.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A data breach is only a privacy issue. -> It may involve both privacy compliance and cybersecurity response, but these are different domains.

Q76. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Biotechnology Fundamentals and DBT Missions, consider the following statements: 1. Proposals are an input; funded projects, pilot plants and marketed products are outputs. Do not upgrade one to the other. 2. BioE3's six thematic sectors: bio-based chemicals and enzymes; functional food and smart proteins; precision biotherapeutics; climate-resilient agriculture; carbon capture and its utilisation; and futuristic marine and space research. 3. "2,000 proposals received" proves BioE3 is delivering. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Proposals are an input; funded projects, pilot plants and marketed products are outputs. Do not upgrade one to the other.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Proposals are an input; funded projects, pilot plants and marketed products are outputs. Do not upgrade one to the other.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception "'2,000 proposals received" proves BioE3 is delivering.' with 'Proposals are an input; funded projects, pilot plants and marketed products are outputs. Do not upgrade one to the other.'. It separately supports statement 2: BioE3's six thematic sectors: bio-based chemicals and enzymes; functional food and smart proteins; precision biotherapeutics; climate-resilient agriculture; carbon capture and its utilisation; and futuristic marine and space research.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "2,000 proposals received" proves BioE3 is delivering. -> Proposals are an input; funded projects, pilot plants and marketed products are outputs. Do not upgrade one to the other.

Q77. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Genetic Engineering, GM Crops and CRISPR, consider the following statements: 1. NHEJ mainly yields random small indels; a precise substitution needs HDR with a template, base editing or prime editing. The mechanisms are distinct. 2. GEAC's 147th meeting on 18 Oct 2022 considered environmental release of transgenic mustard hybrid DMH-11 and parental lines. 3. "CRISPR cuts and the cell makes whatever change we want.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'NHEJ mainly yields random small indels; a precise substitution needs HDR with a template, base editing or prime editing. The mechanisms are distinct.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'NHEJ mainly yields random small indels; a precise substitution needs HDR with a template, base editing or prime editing. The mechanisms are distinct.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception "'CRISPR cuts and the cell makes whatever change we want.'" with 'NHEJ mainly yields random small indels; a precise substitution needs HDR with a template, base editing or prime editing. The mechanisms are distinct.'. It separately supports statement 2: GEAC's 147th meeting on 18 Oct 2022 considered

environmental release of transgenic mustard hybrid DMH-11 and parental lines.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "CRISPR cuts and the cell makes whatever change we want.". -> NHEJ mainly yields random small indels; a precise substitution needs HDR with a template, base editing or prime editing. The mechanisms are distinct.

Q78. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Vaccines, Monoclonal Antibodies and Biopharma, consider the following statements: 1. Regulatory relaxation changes speed/pathway, not the need for evidence and review. 2. CDSCO's official portal hosts both the New Drugs and Clinical Trials Rules, 2019 page and a Vaccines page under biologicals. 3. Emergency or accelerated pathways mean there is no evidence requirement. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Regulatory relaxation changes speed/pathway, not the need for evidence and review.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Regulatory relaxation changes speed/pathway, not the need for evidence and review.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Emergency or accelerated pathways mean there is no evidence requirement.' with 'Regulatory relaxation changes speed/pathway, not the need for evidence and review.'. It separately supports statement 2: CDSCO's official portal hosts both the New Drugs and Clinical Trials Rules, 2019 page and a Vaccines page under biologicals.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Emergency or accelerated pathways mean there is no evidence requirement. -> Regulatory relaxation changes speed/pathway, not the need for evidence and review.

Q79. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Women and Women's Organisations, consider the following statements: 1. The All India Women's Conference was founded in 1927 and initially focused on women's education; it followed earlier organisations such as the Women's Indian Association. 2. SEWA was founded in Gujarat as a trade union of self-employed women workers. 3. The Indian women's movement has always spoken with one unified voice and agenda. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Indian women's movement has always spoken with one unified voice and agenda.' and replaces it with 'Dalit, tribal and class-based women's organisations have historically raised distinct concerns not always centred by upper-caste, urban-led organisations.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Indian women's movement has always spoken with one unified voice and agenda.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Women and Women's Organisations; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Dalit, tribal and class-based women's organisations have historically raised distinct concerns not always centred by upper-caste, urban-led organisations.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Dalit, tribal and class-based women's organisations have historically raised distinct concerns not always centred by upper-caste, urban-led organisations.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Dalit, tribal and class-based women's organisations have historically raised distinct concerns not always centred by upper-caste, urban-led organisations.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Indian women's movement has always spoken with one unified voice and agenda. -> Dalit, tribal and class-based women's organisations have historically raised distinct concerns not always centred by upper-caste, urban-led organisations.

Q80. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Social Empowerment, consider the following statements: 1. Amartya Sen's capability approach reframes development/empowerment around real freedoms, not resources or income alone. 2. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and championed education for women, lower castes and peasants together. 3. Ambedkar sought to reform caste from within Hinduism. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Ambedkar sought to reform caste from within Hinduism.' and replaces it with 'His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Ambedkar sought to reform caste from within Hinduism.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Social Empowerment; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Ambedkar sought to reform caste from within Hinduism. -> His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.

Q81. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Poverty and Developmental Issues, consider the following statements: 1. Amartya Sen's capability approach to poverty distinguishes capability deprivation from income poverty. 2. Oscar Lewis proposed the "culture of poverty" thesis based on his ethnographic fieldwork among poor urban communities; the thesis is widely critiqued in sociology for underplaying structural causes. 3. Government, NGOs and the private sector play identical roles in development collaboration. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Poverty and Developmental Issues; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Each brings a distinct comparative advantage (scale/regulation, grassroots trust, efficiency/resources respectively); effective collaboration divides roles rather than duplicating them.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Government, NGOs and the private sector play identical roles in development collaboration.' and replaces it with 'Each brings a distinct comparative advantage (scale/regulation, grassroots trust, efficiency/resources respectively); effective collaboration divides roles rather than duplicating them.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Government, NGOs and the private sector play identical roles in development collaboration.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Each brings a distinct comparative advantage (scale/regulation, grassroots trust, efficiency/resources respectively); effective collaboration divides roles rather than duplicating them.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Each brings a distinct comparative advantage (scale/regulation, grassroots trust, efficiency/resources respectively); effective collaboration divides roles rather than duplicating them.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Government, NGOs and the private sector play identical roles in development collaboration. -> Each brings a distinct comparative advantage (scale/regulation, grassroots trust, efficiency/resources respectively); effective collaboration divides roles rather than duplicating them.

Q82. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Social Change and Modernisation, consider the following statements: 1. M.N. Srinivas distinguished Sanskritisation (status emulation within existing hierarchy) from Westernisation (new value import) and from modernisation (structural-rational change). 2. Robert Redfield's Great Tradition-Little Tradition framework was applied to Indian village society by McKim Marriott through the universalisation-parochialisation concepts. 3. Structural-functionalism and conflict theory always produce the same explanation for a given social change. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Structural-functionalism and conflict theory always produce the same explanation for a given social change.' and replaces it with 'They offer competing accounts - equilibrium-restoration versus contradiction-driven struggle - and a good answer distinguishes which is more applicable to a given case.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Social Change and Modernisation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They offer competing accounts - equilibrium-restoration versus contradiction-driven struggle - and a good answer distinguishes which is more applicable to a given case.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Structural-functionalism and conflict theory always produce the same explanation for a given social change.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They offer competing accounts - equilibrium-restoration versus contradiction-driven struggle - and a good answer distinguishes which is more applicable to a given case.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They offer competing accounts - equilibrium-restoration versus contradiction-driven struggle - and a good answer distinguishes which is more applicable to a given case.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Structural-functionalism and conflict theory always produce the same explanation for a given social change. -> They offer competing accounts - equilibrium-restoration versus contradiction-driven struggle - and a good answer distinguishes which is more applicable to a given case.

Q83. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Regionalism, consider the following statements: 1. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 restructured Indian states substantially along linguistic lines, the classical historical response to regionalism. 2. Regional disparity is assessed through development indicators (income, infrastructure, human development, fiscal capacity), not cultural or linguistic difference. 3. A composite index score (such as the SDG India Index) fully captures lived regional disparity. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A composite index score (such as the SDG India Index) fully captures lived regional disparity.' and replaces it with 'An index is a useful comparative measurement tool but does not capture the full lived experience of regional disadvantage.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A composite index score (such as the SDG India Index) fully captures lived regional disparity.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Regionalism; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: An index is a useful comparative measurement tool but does not capture the full lived experience of regional disadvantage.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: An index is a useful comparative measurement tool but does not capture the full lived experience of regional disadvantage.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: An index is a useful comparative measurement tool but does not capture the full lived experience of regional disadvantage.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A composite index score (such as the SDG India Index) fully captures lived regional disparity. -> An index is a useful comparative measurement tool but does not capture the full lived experience of regional disadvantage.

Q84. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Internal-Security Foundations and Governance, consider the following statements: 1. Internal security has been a dedicated topic in the Civil Services Main Examination since 2013. 2. Kautilya's Arthashastra is the cited source for the four-fold threat classification (internal, external, internally aided external, externally aided internal). 3. Because police is a State subject, the Centre has no internal-security role. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Because police is a State subject, the Centre has no internal-security role.' and replaces it with 'Union List Entry 2A expressly provides for deployment of armed forces of the Union in a State "in aid of the civil power," and Article 355 places a protective duty on the Union; the design is cooperative, not exclusive, on either side.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Because police is a State subject, the Centre has no internal-security role.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Union List Entry 2A expressly provides for deployment of armed forces of the Union in a State "in aid of the civil power," and Article 355 places a protective duty on the Union; the design is cooperative, not exclusive, on either side.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Internal-Security Foundations and Governance; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Union List Entry 2A expressly provides for deployment of armed forces of the Union in a State "in aid of the civil power," and Article 355 places a protective duty on the Union; the design is cooperative, not exclusive, on either side.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Union List Entry 2A expressly provides for deployment of armed forces of the Union in a State "in aid of the civil power," and Article 355 places a protective duty on the Union; the design is

cooperative, not exclusive, on either side.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Because police is a State subject, the Centre has no internal-security role. -> Union List Entry 2A expressly provides for deployment of armed forces of the Union in a State "in aid of the civil power," and Article 355 places a protective duty on the Union; the design is cooperative, not exclusive, on either side.

Q85. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture, consider the following statements: 1. TADA was in force 1985-1995; POTA, 2002-2004; both were repealed amid misuse concerns. 2. UAPA was enacted in 1967 and amended in 1969, 1972, 1986, 2004, 2008 and 2012; the 2019 amendment (post-dating this book) added designation of individuals as terrorists, Inspector-rank NIA investigation, and DG NIA approval for property attachment in NIA-investigated cases. 3. All named historical attacks and group leadership details in Singh's book remain the current status of those organisations. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'All named historical attacks and group leadership details in Singh's book remain the current status of those organisations.' and replaces it with 'These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: All named historical attacks and group leadership details in Singh's book remain the current status of those organisations.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All named historical attacks and group leadership details in Singh's book remain the current status of those organisations. -> These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.

Q86. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Left-Wing Extremism and Integrated Response, consider the following statements: 1. CPI (Maoist) was formed in 2004 by the merger of the People's War Group (Andhra Pradesh) and the Maoist Communist Centre of India (Bihar). 2. The Maoist doctrine's central slogan is "Political power grows out of the barrel of a gun"; its strategic method is Mao's "Protracted People's War." 3. A district removed from the "LWE-affected" list is a district where the root causes are resolved. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A district removed from the "LWE-affected" list is a district where the root causes are resolved.' and replaces it with 'The list is an administrative classification driving scheme eligibility and force deployment; de-listing records a security-metric change, not the completion of land, forest or service-delivery reform. Keep classification, security outcome and development outcome as three separate claims.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Left-Wing Extremism and Integrated Response; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The list is an administrative classification driving scheme eligibility and force deployment; de-listing records a security-metric change, not the completion of land, forest or service-delivery reform. Keep classification, security outcome and development outcome as three separate claims.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A district removed from the "LWE-affected" list is a district where the root causes are resolved.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The list is an administrative classification driving scheme eligibility and force deployment; de-listing records a security-metric change, not the completion of land, forest or service-delivery reform. Keep classification, security outcome and development outcome as three separate claims.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The list is an administrative classification driving scheme eligibility and force deployment; de-listing records a security-metric change, not the completion of land, forest or service-delivery reform. Keep classification, security outcome and development outcome as three separate claims.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A district removed from the "LWE-affected" list is a district where the root causes are resolved. -> The list is an administrative classification driving scheme eligibility and force deployment; de-listing records a security-metric change, not the completion of land, forest or

service-delivery reform. Keep classification, security outcome and development outcome as three separate claims.

Q87. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes, consider the following statements: 1. Nagaland became a state in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram in 1987; Arunachal Pradesh (formerly NEFA) in 1987. 2. DoNER was created in 2001 and elevated to full ministry status in 2004. 3. Reducing the notified "disturbed area" footprint amounts to repealing AFSPA. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Reducing the notified "disturbed area" footprint amounts to repealing AFSPA.' and replaces it with 'AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Reducing the notified "disturbed area" footprint amounts to repealing AFSPA.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Reducing the notified "disturbed area" footprint amounts to repealing AFSPA. -> AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.

Q88. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Jammu & Kashmir and Cross-Border Terrorism, consider the following statements: 1. Maharaja Hari Singh signed the Instrument of Accession on 26 October 1947. 2. The Line of Control was established after the 1971 war, associated with the subsequent Shimla Agreement. 3. Because J&K now has an elected Assembly, its policing chain works like any other State's. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Because J&K now has an elected Assembly, its policing chain works like any other State's.' and replaces it with 'Under the 2019 Reorganisation Act, public order and police lie outside that Assembly's legislative competence, so the operational chain runs through the Lieutenant Governor and the Union - an internal-security-relevant distinction independent of the constitutional debate.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Because J&K now has an elected Assembly, its policing chain works like any other State's.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Under the 2019 Reorganisation Act, public order and police lie outside that Assembly's legislative competence, so the operational chain runs through the Lieutenant Governor and the Union - an internal-security-relevant distinction independent of the constitutional debate.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Jammu & Kashmir and Cross-Border Terrorism; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Under the 2019 Reorganisation Act, public order and police lie outside that Assembly's legislative competence, so the operational chain runs through the Lieutenant Governor and the Union - an internal-security-relevant distinction independent of the constitutional debate.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Under the 2019 Reorganisation Act, public order and police lie outside that Assembly's legislative competence, so the operational chain runs through the Lieutenant Governor and the Union - an internal-security-relevant distinction independent of the constitutional debate.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Because J&K now has an elected Assembly, its policing chain works like any other State's. -> Under the 2019 Reorganisation Act, public order and police lie outside that Assembly's legislative competence, so the operational chain runs through the Lieutenant Governor and the Union - an internal-security-relevant distinction independent of the constitutional debate.

Q89. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Border Management and Border Area Development, consider the following statements: 1. The India-Pakistan border comprises the Radcliffe Line (~2,308 km), the Line of Control (~776 km) and the Actual Ground Position Line (~110 km). 2. Sir Creek is a 96 km tidal estuary; India relies on the Thalweg (mid-channel) doctrine, Pakistan

on an eastern-bank "green line." 3. India's border with Bangladesh is still riddled with unresolved enclaves and an undelimited maritime boundary. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Border Management and Border Area Development; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: This is Singh's book-period position. The enclaves were exchanged under the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (100th Constitutional Amendment Act) and the maritime boundary was settled by the 2014 arbitral award; the live issues are now migration and river-water sharing.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'India's border with Bangladesh is still riddled with unresolved enclaves and an undelimited maritime boundary.' and replaces it with 'This is Singh's book-period position. The enclaves were exchanged under the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (100th Constitutional Amendment Act) and the maritime boundary was settled by the 2014 arbitral award; the live issues are now migration and river-water sharing.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: India's border with Bangladesh is still riddled with unresolved enclaves and an undelimited maritime boundary.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: This is Singh's book-period position. The enclaves were exchanged under the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (100th Constitutional Amendment Act) and the maritime boundary was settled by the 2014 arbitral award; the live issues are now migration and river-water sharing.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: This is Singh's book-period position. The enclaves were exchanged under the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (100th Constitutional Amendment Act) and the maritime boundary was settled by the 2014 arbitral award; the live issues are now migration and river-water sharing.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: India's border with Bangladesh is still riddled with unresolved enclaves and an undelimited maritime boundary. -> This is Singh's book-period position. The enclaves were exchanged under the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (100th Constitutional Amendment Act) and the maritime boundary was settled by the 2014 arbitral award; the live issues are now migration and river-water sharing.

Q90. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Maritime and Coastal Security, consider the following statements: 1. The Indian Coast Guard was established on 1 February 1977 and formally constituted as the fourth armed force of India by the Coast Guard Act, 1978. 2. The maritime-zone ladder: territorial sea 12 nm, contiguous zone 24 nm, EEZ 200 nm (Maritime Zones Act, 1976, consistent with UNCLOS). 3. Piracy under international law includes any act of maritime violence anywhere at sea. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Piracy under international law includes any act of maritime violence anywhere at sea.' and replaces it with 'Piracy, by definition, occurs on the high seas; violence in India's territorial/inland waters (e.g., the Sunderbans) is analogous but not technically piracy.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Maritime and Coastal Security; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Piracy, by definition, occurs on the high seas; violence in India's territorial/inland waters (e.g., the Sunderbans) is analogous but not technically piracy.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Piracy under international law includes any act of maritime violence anywhere at sea.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Piracy, by definition, occurs on the high seas; violence in India's territorial/inland waters (e.g., the Sunderbans) is analogous but not technically piracy.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Piracy, by definition, occurs on the high seas; violence in India's territorial/inland waters (e.g., the Sunderbans) is analogous but not technically piracy.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Piracy under international law includes any act of maritime violence anywhere at sea. -> Piracy, by definition, occurs on the high seas; violence in India's territorial/inland waters (e.g., the Sunderbans) is analogous but not technically piracy.

Q91. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February 2026): 1. The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. 2. The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

C. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. [Analysis] The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q92. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Economic Survey 2025-26 (29 January 2026): 1. The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. 2. The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

C. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

D. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. [Analysis] The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q93. Answer: A | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Economic Survey growth assessment (29 January 2026): 1. The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. 2. A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

B. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

C. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. [Analysis] A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q94. Answer: B | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about RBI macro-risk assessment (5 August 2026): 1. RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. 2. External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

- B. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.
- C. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.
- D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. [Analysis] External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q95. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about India's 100th Ramsar site milestone (5 June 2026): 1. India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. 2. Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

- A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.
- B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.
- C. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.
- D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. [Analysis] Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q96. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone (31 December 2025): 1. Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. 2. Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

- A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.
- B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.
- C. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.
- D. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

Method / explanation: [Fact] Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. [Analysis] Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q97. Answer: A | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Renewable-capacity addition (31 December 2025): 1. India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. 2. Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is

correct?

A. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

B. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

C. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. [Analysis] Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q98. Answer: B | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex (21 June 2026): 1. PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. 2. An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

B. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

C. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. [Analysis] An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q99. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch (13 January 2026): 1. India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. 2. Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

C. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

D. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. [Analysis] Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q100. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following statements about BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement (16 May 2026): 1. The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four

states then recorded as having deposited instruments. 2. Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. 3. Replacing the competent institution with a neighbouring constitutional or international body would not alter the accuracy of the claim. Which one of the following is correct?

A. Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is valid and statement 3 is not.

B. Statements 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 1 is incorrect. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the dated official record supports statement 1, while statement 3 remains false.

C. All three statements are correct. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: institutional substitution can change competence, legal status and the truth of the claim.

D. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, while statement 3 is incorrect. - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 are factually sound; statement 3 is false because institutional identity is often the decisive UPSC distinction.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. [Analysis] Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS